

Azure Account Setup and Portal Familiarization Report

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1. Project Overview

This project demonstrates the creation of a Microsoft Azure account, exploration of the Azure Portal, configuration of governance and billing settings, deployment of a test resource, and implementation of security best practices. The exercise also covers Azure Free Tier benefits, budget monitoring, and Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) preparation.

2. Account Creation Documentation

Objective

Create a Microsoft Azure account and complete identity verification.

Steps Performed

1. Visited the Azure Free Account page.
2. Signed in using a Microsoft account.
3. Completed email verification.
4. Completed phone number verification using a One-Time Password (OTP).
5. Added a valid payment method for identity verification.
6. Accepted Microsoft Azure terms and conditions.
7. Successfully accessed the Azure Portal dashboard.

Successful Azure Account Creation / Azure Portal Home Page

3. Azure Portal Navigation

Logging into Azure Portal

1. Open portal.azure.com.

2. Enter Microsoft account credentials.
3. Complete authentication.

Main Navigation Areas

- Home
- Dashboard
- Resource Groups
- Virtual Machines
- Storage Accounts
- Cost Management + Billing
- Microsoft Entra ID
- Monitor

Search Functionality

The Azure Portal search bar allows quick access to services and resources.

Breadcrumb Navigation

Azure uses breadcrumb navigation to show the current resource location and assist navigation between services.

Azure Portal Dashboard

Azure Search Function Demonstration

4. Dashboard Customization

Objective

Customize the Azure Dashboard to improve accessibility and monitoring.

Steps

1. Open Dashboard.
2. Select "Edit."
3. Add service tiles.
4. Arrange tiles logically.
5. Save dashboard layout.

Suggested Layout

- Resource Groups
- Storage Accounts
- Cost Management
- Microsoft Entra ID
- Recent Resources

Customized Dashboard

5. Governance Setup

Subscription Identification

1. Search for "Subscriptions."
2. Select active subscription.
3. Verify subscription status.

Resource Group Creation

Resource Group Name:
RG-Lab01

Region:
East US

Subscription Overview

Resource Group Creation

6. Resource Deployment

Storage Account Deployment

Resource Type:
Storage Account

Region:
East US

Performance:
Standard

Redundancy:
Locally Redundant Storage (LRS)

Deployment Steps

1. Search Storage Accounts.
2. Select Create.
3. Enter configuration details.
4. Validate settings.
5. Deploy resource.

Storage Account Successfully Deployed

7. Billing and Cost Management

Accessing Cost Management

1. Search Cost Management + Billing.
2. Open Cost Analysis.
3. Review current usage.

Azure Free Tier Benefits

New Azure accounts generally include:

Initial Credit

- USD \$200 credit for the first 30 days.

12-Month Free Services

Examples include:

- Azure Virtual Machines (selected limits)
- Azure Blob Storage
- Azure Files
- Azure SQL Database
- Azure Bandwidth

Always-Free Services

Examples include:

- Azure Functions
- Event Grid

- Azure Advisor
- Azure DevTest Labs

Note: Service availability and quotas may change over time.

8. Budget Alert Configuration

Budget Configuration

Budget Name:
FreeTierBudget

Threshold:
75%

Notification Type:
Email Alert

Configuration Steps

1. Open Cost Management.
2. Select Budgets.
3. Create Budget.
4. Set monthly budget.
5. Configure alert threshold at 75%.
6. Add notification email.
7. Save configuration.

Budget Alert Configured at 75% Threshold